

Monica Cholico

Creative Developer & Visual Storyteller

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Dear Jessica Ma,

I'm a Web Engineer on the TBrand Creative Tech Team, and I'm writing to express my interest in the Design Developer role on the Opinion team. In my daily work I use a stack that includes JavaScript, TypeScript, React, and sometimes Svelte, and I integrate best practices while working with AI-assisted tools such as Cursor and Copilot. While the business side of what I do is exciting, being part of the journalism mission — bringing ideas and transforming them into digital storytelling experiences for our readers — is the direction I want to shift and grow in.

For the past five years at the Times, I've built templates and bespoke interactive experiences for our advertisers, bridging creative vision and functional code, building interactive, pixel-perfect experiences, conducting QA across devices and browsers, working closely with designers, editors, producers and cross-functional partners. I've taken projects from concept through technical design to production, including reusable template systems that other teams depend on. This work has given me a strong foundation in building responsive layouts and reliable, scalable web applications within the standards and pace of this organization.

I'm eager to apply these engineering skills to journalism. I'm a curious, creative person with a backlog of data-driven story ideas I want to build. I'm driven to understand, learn and share how the world works — something I think comes from my humanities background, including a bachelor's in law — and I think editorially, question constantly and look for ways technology can help people better understand the world.

I truly believe people make better decisions when they have information on their side. Outside of work, I've been building toward this on my own time. Planeta Mujer (www.planeta-mujer.org) is an interactive platform I designed and coded from scratch. To share these subjects through scrollytelling, interaction and visualization, I've been exploring and teaching myself technologies outside my daily work such as D3.js, the Canvas API, Three.js and GLSL. I enjoy the whole process, from prototyping an idea to implementing it into something real. I also write bilingual explanatory articles for a blog I've run since 2014.

I hold a master's in gender and social policy. In 2025 I completed a course in Statistics and Probability for Data Analysis; this year I finished a graduate diploma in digital experiences, marketing and ecosystems; and I'm currently working toward NYU's Modern Journalism certificate, which I'll complete at the end of the year.

I believe my technical skills as a front-end software engineer, my editorial curiosity, and my drive to build things make me a strong candidate for this team.

Sincerely,

Monica Cholico